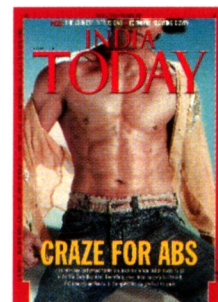


mail of the week

MANPREET ROMALIA



"Craze for Abs",
October 15, 2007

"Instead of laying stress on eating right and exercising, the magazine is promoting surgeries to get the right look, which is totally unwarranted."

ALOK MISHRA, *Bangalore*

It's the Pack-age

Brains seem to have taken a backseat with brawn being the highlight of the season ("Craze for Abs", October 15). As more and more men take the shorter route to instant good looks, slower methods like yoga have gone for a six. K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, *Bangalore*

The craze for abs only highlights the stark contrast between the rich and the poor. The need of the hour is to be able to meet the basic health requirements of the people. A. JACOB SAHAYAM, *Thiruvananthapuram*

Thanks to the continuous coverage and idolisation of well sculpted bodies by the media, today's men are increasingly becoming insecure about their physical appearance. M.M. GURBAXANI, *Bangalore*

The so-called abs look artificial and a bit scary. Where has the natural body gone? The race to acquire that perfect six-pack is not about being healthy but being saleable. Let's not trade good health for money. MADHU SINGH, *Ambala*

Men are now discovering the need to look good and do not mind spending hours at the gym for that perfect look, a far cry from the days when they taunted women about being obsessed with their appearance. PRIYA SOOD, *on e-mail*

False Alarm

By threatening time and again to withdraw support to the Government, the Left is trying to buy time to strengthen its votebank ("Not If But When", October 15). The reason for not pulling out yet is the fear of early elections as they are sure to lose

their vote share.

A. SRIKANTIAH, *Bangalore*

Courting Justice

Rural courts will go a long way in relieving the judiciary of the heavy backlog of cases ("Rural Rulings", October 15). The Government should strengthen this system by appointing more nyayadhikaris.

K. PRADEEP, *Chennai*

Nat-Trick?

Beating anti-incumbency and winning the Assembly elections third time in a row may seem to be an onerous task, but it is difficult for Narendra Modi ("And Now the Slog Overs", October 15). Though facing dissent from some of his own ranks, the Opposition is in disarray, which may swing the tide in his favour. D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Though Modi has been blowing his trumpet about the economic progress in Gujarat under his rule, the

communal angle of his regime cannot be overlooked. The Muslims in his state have been denied the basic rights and liberties. He was able to win the 2002 elections on sentimental grounds, not so this time.

A. ANTONY PRABHU, *Thiruvananthapuram*

Economical Bite

Though quite enlightening, the BITE conference did not touch upon corruption, an evil that pervades all levels of our development machinery ("Slowing Down", October 15). Another connected issue is the size of our ministries, which has so far been only moving upwards, thus, resulting in an increase in expenditure.

M.L. KARWALL, *Jalandhar*

The treatise of the Board of INDIA TODAY Economists is outdated. The views of the economists are quite diverse and doesn't present a